F Sum 1 Grammar notes

REVISION: Verb forms from Michaelmas

> - **Make sure you can remember all of the following points about verb forms from this year. References are given to help you.**

- How to conjugate in the present tense all the **regular –ER verbs** given in Mich 1, and **AVOIR, ÊTRE** and **ALLER**.

- Make sure that you are aware of and can remember from Mich 3 the present tense spelling changes for:
  - **-GER verbs**
  - **-CER verbs**
  - **-YER verbs**
  - **E/É-consonant-ER verbs**
  - **APPELER, RAPPELER** and **JETER**

- Conjugate in the present tense all of the **regular –IR verbs** from Mich 5

- Be able to conjugate into the present tense **two different sorts of irregular –IR verbs** from Mich 5:
  - First 3 or 4 letter stem verbs
  - -IR verbs that use –ER endings

- Learn the irregular verbs **MOURIR** and **VENIR** from Mich 5
- Learn the **6 irregular –OIR present tense verbs** from Mich 9
- Be able to conjugate **regular –RE verbs** from Mich 11
- Learn the **four irregular present tense –RE verbs** in Mich 11
- Learn the **8 irregular present tense –IRE verbs** from Lent 3

Comparative/Superlative adjectives: *bigger, the biggest*

- We already know a lot about adjectives. We know that adjectives in French have to agree, that the vast majority of adjectives go after the noun they describe, though a small number of very common adjectives go before. Some adjectives change their meaning, depending on where they go. Look back to Michaelmas Chapters 7 and 9 if you need to.

- **To compare things**, i.e. say what is more X or less Y than something else is very easy in French. In English some adjectives have the word "more" put it front of them (*MORE interesting*) and others have "-er" added on the end "*smallER*". In French only the first option exists. **Simply add "PLUS" in front of the adjective.**
  - *plus intéressant* *plus petit*

- The adjective goes in its usual place, and agrees as usual
  - *un livre plus intéressant* *une plus petite fille*

- To compare one thing with another, simply use the following structures:
  - **PLUS** **adj QUE** more…than
  - **AUSSI** **adj QUE** as…as
  - **MOINS** **adj QUE** less…than
  - **ne…pas SI** **adj QUE** not as…as

  - *nous sommes aussi polis que vous*
    ils sont moins élégants que leur femme
    elle n'est pas si intelligente que toi

- To use **a superlative (the bigGEST, the MOST interesting),** simply place "**LE/LA/LES PLUS** before the **ADJECTIVE** (agreeing with the noun), wherever it comes. To say the opposite, (the LEAST big, the LEAST interesting), simply use **MOINS** instead of PLUS
  - *le livre le plus intéressant*
    la plus petite fille
    les moins grandes chaises

- If with your superlative you want to say "**IN the world, IN the room**" etc, French uses **DE** rather than "dans".
  - *La plus jolie fille de la classe*
    Le journal le plus lu du monde

- Finally a couple of essential **irregular comparisons and superlatives**:
  - *good/bad* *better/worse* *the best/the worst*
    bon **meilleur(e/s)** **le/la/les meilleur(e/s)**
  - **mauvais** **pire*** **le/la/les pire(s)***
    (* or plus mauvais) (*or le/la/les plus mauvais(e/s))